
MEETING MINUTES

Ad Hoc Subcommittee on Handbook Process

May 8, 2024

1. Roll Call for Attendance - 3/0

Agenda

As approved by the committee on February 4, 2024, Item 2024-8.

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee will establish an ad hoc subcommittee to establish a process and norms around annual handbook review per the resolution passed unanimously on 11/20/2024 (2023-26).

Be it also resolved that the subcommittee will be established at the February 5th School Committee meeting and will work to complete the process as close to the original deadline of April 1, 2024 as reasonably possible.

CHCA-B - HANDBOOK REVIEW AND SCHEDULE

The School Committee is required to approve school handbooks annually. Preparations for annual approval of the school handbooks will be scheduled in phases throughout the school year with attention to certain deadlines.

Phase I - Initiation of Handbook Update Process

Target Dates: August 1 to September 30

1. The Superintendent will create versions of each school handbook to become the draft for the upcoming school year;
2. The draft handbooks will be updated to incorporate changes mandated by School Committee policy, district policy, law, regulation, and legal rulings impacting the content of the handbook;
3. A memorandum will be created explaining each change and the source or reason for the change and be named "Mandatory Changes Memorandum";
4. A copy of the handbook prior to changes, the draft handbook, the memorandum explaining changes, and a copy of this policy will be sent to each school principal.

Phase II - School Council Drafting of Handbook Changes

Target dates: October 1 to January 31

1. The School Council will make updates to the draft handbook;

2. The School Council will create a memorandum explaining each change and the source or reason for the change and be named "School Council Changes Memorandum";
3. The School Council will send the recommended handbook and memorandum to the Superintendent.
4. The Superintendent will review for consistency where appropriate between handbooks across the district and create a memorandum explaining changes made to the recommended handbooks after School Council approval and provide the memorandum to the School Council and the School Committee in the approval process.

Phase III - Committee Review and Approval

Target Dates: February 1 to April 30

1. "Review and Approval of School Year XX Handbooks" will be placed on a Regular School Committee Meeting agenda;
2. The School Committee will receive copies of the handbook prior to changes, the recommended handbook, the Mandatory Changes Memorandum, and the School Council Changes Memorandum;
3. The School Committee will take action such as approval, amendment to a handbook, or postpone approval to a subsequent meeting, committee of the whole, or subcommittee meeting. Approval can only be made in whole of a handbook.

Policy Information

First Adopted: TBD

Last Amended: None

Last Reviewed: None

Review Frequency: two (2) years

Next Review: TBD

Version: 1

Policy ID: CHCA-B

Original Source: None

Legal References: M.G.L. [71:59C](#), [71:37H](#)

A copy of the recommended policy will be sent to central administration and principals so they may provide feedback at the regular school committee meeting where the policy will be considered.

Motion to report policy CHCA-B out to the full committee for adoption with subcommittee recommendation for approval by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Intoppa 3/0 passed

***Motion to adjourn by member Reinfeld, second by Member Intoppa - 3/0
Meeting adjourned at 4:11 p.m.***